

Janhit Foundation - Newsletter

January 2012



Director's Message

As we welcome in the New Year, I am mindful that we have just ended 2011. For us, it has been a year of growth, progress & promise.

As we begin this New Year, we will focus our efforts on strategic planning which will provide guidance for our future direction, priorities and development of the organization.

I look forward to the challenges that this year will bring, as we continue moving ahead and work towards our goal of improving human welfare in our locality.

I wish you all a Happy and Healthy New Year!

Anita Rana
Director, Janhit Foundation

Janhit Foundation is an independent, not-for-profit non-governmental organization, actively engaged in the promotion of human welfare through environmental protection since 1998.

Janhit Foundation was registered on August 04, 1998 Under the Societies Registration Act, 1860.

Key areas of work include:

- Groundwater quality protection for human health.
- Provision of safe drinking water to marginalized communities.
- Protection of river water quality for aquatic ecosystems.
- Enhancement of available water resources through water conservation measures.
- Promotion of sustainable agriculture by organic farming methods.
- Environmental education and empowerment of local communities.
- Meerut Childline: a 24/7 helpline for children in need.

Janhit Foundation undertakes this work through scientific research, campaigns, advocacy and grass-root level community involvement.

Vision

As a public interest organisation, Janhit Foundation focuses on strengthening local communities through their active participation in decision making, to achieve sustainable development. We believe that environmental degradation can only be addressed adequately if local people are empowered in decision making at all levels and have control over resources.

To achieve our goals, we work in partnership with government, non-governmental, national and international organisations on environment and human rights issues.

Janhit Foundation
180/7 Shastri Nagar
Meerut – 250002
Uttar Pradesh, India
P +91 121 276 3418
F +91 121 276 318

www.janhitfoundation.in

Water

January 2012

Farewell from Matthew Bell

In October I arrived at Janhit Foundation from the UK, and had the opportunity to spend five weeks working with the organization. Whilst I had no prior work experience in the voluntary or environmental sectors, I studied Archaeology and Geography at University in the UK, and have extensive experience of proposal and report writing. As such I arrived with high hopes that I would be able to contribute positively to Janhit's work.

During my time here I found myself heavily involved in their ongoing work across the fields of organic agriculture, water conservation and child rights. These initiatives led me to assist with agricultural training days, Childline Se Dosti, and school education programs. Their success and the positive response from the local community members involved are testament to the reputation of Janhit in Western Uttar Pradesh, and their successful work.

Alongside this, I spent the majority of my time writing and designing further projects to enable the organization to further their goal of achieving sustainable development for the local communities across all spheres of life.

I would like to thank the people at Janhit Foundation for welcoming me and for supporting me during my time in India. My time here was a thoroughly rewarding experience, and I hope the work I completed during this period helps the organization to continue the valuable work they undertake in the local communities.



National Round Table - India Water Partnership

India Water Partnership (IWP) in association with the National Institute of Disaster Management (NIDM), Ministry of Home Affairs, organized a two day meeting on “**Climate change & Disaster Management**” on 25th & 26th Nov 2011 at NIDM Conference Hall, New Delhi with the aim of formulating a strategy document for future policy & programme interventions for different stakeholders in reference to Climate change & Disaster Risk reduction. The program was addressed by Dr.Satendra, Executive Director NIDM, Dr.Alok N.Sharma, Vice-President, along with other honorable members of IWP, NIDM and other reputed Institutes.

Key issues discussed

- Scientific explanation of increasing extreme events turning into disaster in India (hydro meteorological);
- Risk Reduction strategy for changing vulnerability profile of the country at the local level;
- Capacity of the stakeholders to cope with mitigation, adaptation and Disaster Risk Management;
- Innovation for unconventional strategy for sustainable development;
- Food Security, poverty and safety with inclusive strategy; and,
- Land and Water Management



Sustainable Agriculture

January 2012



Agricultural Training Programme:

Seed Banks, Organic Pesticides and Bio-fertilizers

A one day training programme was organized by Janhit Foundation with the support of Oxfam India. The training focused on the creation and establishment of a seed bank, and the production and use of organic pesticides and bio-fertilizers and was held in the villages of Malipur, Badhoully, Megraipur and Narangpur.

All local farmers were encouraged to participate in the events, which were conducted by the agricultural scientist, Dr. Sandeep Tomar. Farmers were advised that foundation seed should be utilized with tags and labels and should be grown in a scientific manner, supervised by a seed certifying agency. Mr. Rohit Kumar gave important tips to the farmers with regard to the type of bio-fertilizers and pesticides which should be used for organic production. A Question and Answer session was then held by our project coordinator, Mr. Devpal Singh, to clear up any further queries.



Raising the profile of organic agriculture

Janhit Foundation also conducted various educational drives in the villages of Khatki, Khaspur, Nagloma, Shikhera, Pooth and Dhanpura. These events were aimed at promoting sustainable farming practices and encouraging farmers to adopt organic agriculture. These programmes were once again supported by Oxfam India.

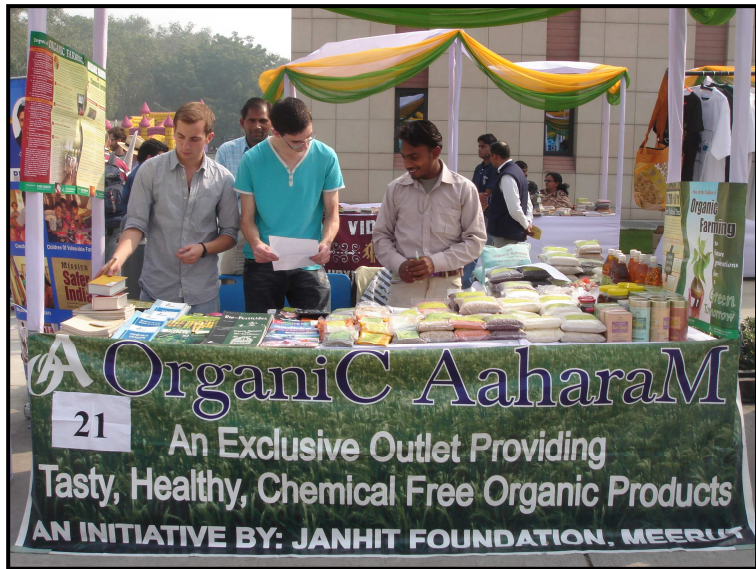


Agricultural scientist, Mr. Kanta Prasad from Meerut Agricultural University coordinated the sessions and explained to farmers the benefits of farming sustainably and the techniques needed to adopt these practices. Farmers were also provided with various information and practical guidance on how to produce their own bio-fertilizers and organic pesticides and how and when these should be used to the greatest effect. Advice was also provided with regard to the formulation of community self-help groups to aid farmers whilst they were learning new farming methodologies.



Sustainable Agriculture

January 2012



Australian High Commission – Oz Haat Mela

On December 3rd, 2011, the Australian Government organized a fair at the Australian High Commission, in New Delhi. A wide range of craftwork along with organic food products were showcased at various stalls, which were run by NGOs from all over the country.

Janhit Foundation participated in this event and set-up a stall of organic products, grown by the organic farmers of Western Uttar Pradesh. Customers showed a keen interest in the purchase of organic products and a record number of sales were recorded. Chief Programme Coordinator, Mr. Devpal Singh accompanied by Mr. Matthew Bell & Mr. Duncan Craig represented Janhit Foundation on the day.



IAS Officers Wives Association Winter Carnival

On December 17, 2011, the IAS Officers Wives Association celebrated its Annual Function at PSOI, Chanakyapuri, New Delhi. A fair was organized to celebrate the event, in which Janhit Foundation participated, in association with the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) Small Grants Programme. Janhit Foundation ran a stall selling the produce of the organic farmers of Western Uttar Pradesh. A specific demand was seen for organic products such as Jaggery, Sugar and Turmeric, whilst customers expressed a keen interest in becoming regular buyers of our organic produce and expressed a desire for our products to be more widely available.



Childline

January 2012

Childline Se Dosti Week

It was with great pride and honour that Meerut Childline celebrated the awareness campaign, *CHILDLINE SE DOSTI WEEK* from November 8th to the 14th, 2011.

A huge effort was made by Meerut Childline to spread awareness amongst the general public through this campaign. The week long event included the activity of Suraksha Bandhan - the tying of Childline wrist bands on administrative personnel in Government offices.

Meerut Childline also coordinated a signature campaign, the taking of the Childline Oath and a medical camp within a local slum.

The week culminated in the viewing of the Ranji-Trophy match by the children and a cricket match contested by two teams of children from a local slum. Once this was complete, an awards ceremony was carried out at Childline Meerut's office, during which the children were provided with food and gifts and they celebrated with music and dancing.



Open Education School

Meerut CHILDLINE undertook a survey of families and children residing in Lohia Nagar Colony and based on the results, established an Open School in the vicinity. A Childline Volunteer takes the classes and provides informal elementary education to the children on a regular basis. At present, there are currently more than 50 children attending this school.

Spreading the light of literacy

In conjunction with MSW students, a survey was undertaken of a local slum and a congregation of families living on by the side of Ch. Charan Singh Road. This study identified a number of children who were not attending school, due mainly to financial problems. Subsequently, our Childline service has managed to admit all of these children to a government school.

Diwali celebration with Big Bazaar in Bal-Sadan

On October 23, 2011, Meerut Childline was delighted to join hands with BIG BAZAAR, Meerut to celebrate Diwali with children in BAL SADAN. All the children enthusiastically participated in all the activities. The children were made to play Antakshari, whilst some of them sang songs, recited poems, all in all making for a memorable evening. The program was concluded with a cake-cutting ceremony and the distribution of gifts and sweets amongst all the children present.



Child Rights Rally

On December 29, 2011, Meerut Childline in association with some public schools of Meerut organized a programme on CHILD RIGHTS in the campus of Government Inter College. Around 1000 students along with their Principals and teachers from different Public Schools participated in this programme, including S.D. Sadar, M.P.G.S., Guru Tegh Bahadur, C.A.V., Govt. Inter College, Ramchandra Kanya Inter College.

The programme was operated by Labor Officer Mr. A. K. Gupta. Also present at the event were Dr. Ompal Singh, Principal of S.D. Sadar, Dr. Mrinalini Anant, Principal of M.P.G.S., Ms. Anita Rana, Director of Meerut Childline and Mr. Tarachand Shastri, Director of Meerut Public School.

Ms. Anita Rana made all the children aware about Meerut Childline 1098 and asked for everyone's continued support for the noble cause. Then, Mr. A.K. Gupta gave a presentation on child rights & how Childline and the Labor Department function in this area. Students from Meerut Public Girls School then presented a skit on Child Labour.

After this event, all the children formed a Rally and marched through the city raising their voices for Human and Child Rights.



Slum children meet the Commissioner

On November 10th, 2011, 14 children from Sarai-Kazi village and Lohia Nagar colony accepted an invite from Meerut Commissioner, Mr. Bhuvnesh Kumar to attend his residence for evening tea. Mr. Kumar personally met all the children and talked to them about their education and families. He also told them about the significance of education and moral values in their life. This eventful and pleasant evening will be remembered by children for the rest of their life.

Another Feather in Childline's Cap

Celebrating its tenth year in existence, Big Bazaar approached us for our support on their CSR campaign "Community Seva". They collected old clothes, books, toys from staff and customers and donated these to needy children during the Christmas period in Slum areas in association with Meerut CHILDLINE. For this campaign, Big Bazaar utilized Meerut Childline's logo in store, serving as a great communication tool for Childline.

Child Right's Educational Programme

On Human Rights day, various programmes were organized in public schools throughout Meerut. Childline's Director, Ms. Anita Rana participated in such programmes in Meerut Public Girls School and Delhi Public School, Meerut. She gave a presentation on Child Rights and informed students of the work of Childline and how it can improve the lives of distressed children.

Childline

4 Students begin internship with Janhit Foundation

WELCOME!

Janhit Foundation is delighted to welcome the arrival of four volunteers to our organization. Three of these volunteers, Mr. Arpit Agarwal, Mr. Apar Bansal and Mr. Nitin Gupta, are MBA students from Mumbai, whom will be working at Janhit Foundation for a period of three weeks. The fourth volunteer, Ms. Pushpinder Kaur, is currently pursuing an MSc in Development and Communications in Bangalore and will be working with our organization for around the next two and a half months.

Over the next month, Mr. Agarwal, Mr. Bansal and Mr. Gupta will be undertaking a survey of the health of the inhabitants of Nangla Mal village, amongst other tasks, whilst Ms. Kaur will be working on various research projects for Meerut Childline and assisting with our communications strategy.



JANHIT FOUNDATION

180/7 Shastri Nagar

Meerut - 250002

Uttar Pradesh

India



3 days CAMP at Badri Narayan Seva Kendra

To close the year, Badri Narayan Seva Kendra organized a three day children's camp. Meerut Childline sent 6 children along with some team members to participate in this camp. Children were given training on Yoga, Meditation, Health, Food, and how to best help other people in need.

These moral values were instilled in them so that they can bring about a good change in their lives, maintain good personal health and attain a better education.

On the last day of camp, a cultural program was organized in which all the children participated. The children who came from Meerut Childline performed a skit, "Chatur vyakti ki khoj". After the skit, Childline staff ensured that all the children present at the camp were aware of CHILDLINE 1098, and the 24 hour assistance that it offers.

**Once again thank you for
your continued and
valued support. All the
very best for the year of
2012!**